



SUJET STATAPP 325 - 2026-2027

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Organisme : CREST

Catégorie : Sociologie Quantitative

Sujet :

Has there been a polarization of working hours? Analysis of the European Union Labor Force Survey

Description du sujet :

Both academic and public debates suggest that there has been a polarization of working hours. Some people are working very short hours?the underemployed, and some work very long hours?the overworked. Further, longer hours are concentrated among those with higher earnings and shorter hours among those with low earnings. Such a polarization has important consequences, not just for social inequality overall, but also for the lives of the individual workers.

But is this actually true? This Stat'App will investigate this question by analyzing long-running survey data to assess trends in working hours across European countries. We will make use of unconditional quantile regression and Oaxaca-Blinder decompositions. These models enable us to understand, which group, like single-mothers or physicians, contribute to changes in the working hour distribution over time.

Statistical software will be Stata or R, depending on the students' preferences.

At the end of this project, students will have:

- An excellent understanding of unconditional quantile regression and decomposition; a flexible technique that is becoming the standard in the analysis of the distribution of continuous outcome variables such as wealth, wages, test scores, birth weight, or house prices.
- An excellent understanding of the EU Labor Force Survey, the largest European household sample survey, collected by the EU statistical office Eurostat, and a premier source of information both for EU public policy and academic research.
- With effort, perseverance, and a bit of luck students might publish an article in an international peer-reviewed journal.

Données du sujet :

The EU Labor Force Survey (EU-LFS) is organized by the EU statistical office Eurostat and it is the largest European household sample survey. Its main purpose for the EU is to calculate the monthly unemployment rate in the EU, yet the survey has vastly greater potential for research purposes due to its long time line, large sample size, and cross-national comparability. Microdata are available from 1992 into the present, for up to 35 European countries. More information about the European Union Labor Force Survey can be found on the Eurostat website: <https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/web/microdata/european-union-labour-force-survey>

Modèles envisagés du sujet :

Unconditional quantile regression and Oaxaca-Blinder decompositions to identify which groups (e.g., single mothers, physicians) contribute to changes in the working hour distribution over time. Statistical software: Stata or R, depending on student preference.

Bibliographie du sujet :

Firpo, Sergio P., Nicole M. Fortin, and Thomas Lemieux. 2018. "Decomposing Wage Distributions Using Recentered Influence Function Regressions." *Econometrics* 6(2):28. <https://doi.org/10.3390/econometrics6020028>. This article uses

both unconditional quantile regression as well as decompositions, looking at wages.

Jacobs, Jerry A., and Kathleen Gerson. 2004. *The Time Divide. Work, Family, and Gender Inequality*. Harvard University Press. This book is one of the first sociologist works claiming the existence of working hours polarization, but based only on US data.

Wooldridge, Jeffrey M. 2010. *Econometric Analysis of Cross Section and Panel Data*, 2nd ed. MIT Press.

Wooldridge, Jeffrey M. 2016. *Introductory Econometrics. A Modern Approach*, 6th ed. Cengage.

Notation du sujet :

Commentaires :